

ENG502

→ Language: A Purely Human and Non-Instinctive Communication

Language is a unique and complex system of communication exclusive to humans. Unlike animals, humans possess the ability to create and understand complex linguistic structures, enabling us to convey thoughts, emotions, and ideas. This capacity for language is not innate but learned through experience and interaction.

→ Language: A Symbol System

Language operates as a symbol system, where sounds, words, and gestures represent concepts, objects, and ideas. These symbols hold arbitrary meanings agreed upon by language users. The English language, for instance, uses a combination of alphabets, phonemes, and morphemes to convey meaning.

→ Behavioristic View of Language

The behavioristic perspective views language as a learned behavior shaped by environment, experience, and reinforcement. This theory suggests that language acquisition occurs through interaction with others, imitation, and conditioning. In English language learning, behavioristic approaches emphasize repetition, drill, and practice.

→ Structural View of Language

The structural perspective examines language's internal structure, comprising sounds (phonology), words (morphology), sentences (syntax), and meaning (semantics). English language's structural components, such as verb tenses and clause structures, work together to convey meaning.

→ Miscellaneous Definitions of Language

Language definitions vary, including system of signs and symbols, tool for communication, expression of thought and feeling, and social construct. These perspectives highlight language's multifaceted nature, emphasizing its role in shaping identity, culture, and society.

→ History of Language

Compilation

Language has evolved over time, influenced by geographical, cultural, and social factors. English language's history, for example, spans Old English, Middle English, and Modern English, reflecting the impact of Norman Conquest, Renaissance, and colonialism.

➡ **Animal Communication and Language**

Animal communication differs significantly from human language. While animals use vocalizations, gestures, and chemical signals, their systems lack the complexity, creativity, and symbolic nature of human language.

➡ **Talking Apes**

Studies on talking apes, such as chimpanzees and bonobos, demonstrate their capacity for language acquisition. However, their linguistic abilities differ fundamentally from humans', highlighting the unique characteristics of human language.

➡ **Written Language**

Written language emerged around 5,000 years ago, revolutionizing communication and knowledge transmission. English language's written form has evolved from runes to modern alphabets.

➡ **First Families**

Language families, such as Indo-European and Sino-Tibetan, group languages based on shared ancestry. English belongs to the Germanic branch of Indo-European languages.

➡ **Towards a Science of Language**

Linguistics, the scientific study of language, seeks to understand language's structure, evolution, and use. English language linguistics examines phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, and semantics.

➡ **Origin of Language**

Theories on language origin include:

- The Divine Source: Language as a gift from God.
- The Natural Sound Source: Language emerging from natural sounds.
- The Social Interaction Source: Language developing through human interaction.
- The Physical Adaptation Source: Language adapting to physical environment.
- The Tool-Making Source: Language emerging with tool use.
- The Genetic Source: Language influenced by genetics.

➡ **Characteristics of Human Language**

- **Displacement:** Language can refer to past, present, or future.
- **Arbitrariness:** Words have no inherent meaning.
- **Productivity:** Language allows creativity.
- **Cultural Transmission:** Language passed through culture.
- **Duality:** Language consists of sounds and meaning.

→ **Functions of Language (Verbal Communication)**

Language serves various purposes, including expression, persuasion, control, and performance. Verbal communication facilitates information exchange, relationship building, and social interaction.

→ **Language is Expressive**

Language enables users to convey thoughts, emotions, and experiences. Through vocabulary, tone, and syntax, speakers express themselves, shaping their identity and relationships.

→ **Language is Powerful**

Language influences others, shaping perceptions and actions. Powerful language can inspire, persuade, or manipulate, highlighting its impact on social dynamics.

→ **Language as a Means of Control**

Language regulates behavior, enforcing social norms and expectations. Authority figures use language to direct, command, or prohibit actions.

→ **Language is Performative**

Language accomplishes actions, such as promising, apologizing, or congratulating. Performative language has real-world consequences.

→ **Language: A Dynamic and Relational Entity**

Language constantly evolves, influenced by context, culture, and interaction. Its relational nature connects individuals, groups, and societies.

→ **NONVERBAL COMMUNICATION**

Nonverbal cues convey information beyond verbal language.

→ **Aspects of Nonverbal Communication**

Nonverbal communication involves:

- Facial expressions
- Body language
- Eye contact
- Touch
- Proximity
- Tone and pitch

➡ **Principles of Nonverbal Communication**

Effective nonverbal communication relies on:

- Consistency
- Congruence
- Contextualization

Conveyance of Interpersonal and Emotional Messages

Nonverbal cues convey emotions, attitudes, and relationships.

More Involuntary than Verbal

Nonverbal communication often occurs unconsciously.

More Ambiguous

Nonverbal cues can be open to interpretation.

More Credible

Nonverbal communication can be more trustworthy than verbal language.

➡ **Types of Nonverbal Communication**

- Kinesics (body language)
- Haptics (touch)
- Vocalics (tone/pitch)
- Proxemics (space)
- Chronemics (time)

➡ **Learning Kinesics**

Kinesics involves studying body language, gestures, and posture.

➡ **Haptics**

Haptics explores touch and physical contact.

➡ **Vocalics**

Vocalics examines tone, pitch, and vocal qualities.

➡ **Proxemics**

Proxemics investigates spatial relationships.

➡ **Chronemics**

Chronemics studies time and temporal relationships

➡ **Animal vs. Human Communication**

Human communication differs from animal communication in creativity, discreteness, interchangeability, and semanticity.

➡ **Interchangeability**

Human language enables substitution of equivalent words or sounds.

➡ **Semanticity**

Human language conveys meaning beyond physical reality.

➡ **WHAT IS LINGUISTICS?**

Linguistics is the scientific study of language structure, use, and evolution. It examines language as a system, exploring sound, grammar, meaning, and context.

➡ **Explicitness**

Linguistics aims to make language structures and rules explicit, providing clear descriptions and explanations.

➡ **Systematicness**

Linguistics approaches language as a complex system, analyzing its components and relationships.

➡ **Objectivity**

Linguistics strives for objectivity, avoiding personal biases and focusing on empirical evidence.

Compilation

→ The Scope of Linguistics

Linguistics encompasses various subfields, including:

- Phonetics (sound)
- Phonology (sound systems)
- Morphology (word structure)
- Syntax (sentence structure)
- Semantics (meaning)
- Pragmatics (communication)

→ Intra-disciplinary Branches of Linguistics

1. General-Linguistics: Studies language universals and theoretical foundations.
2. Descriptive-Linguistics: Documents and describes languages.
3. Comparative Linguistics: Compares languages to identify similarities and differences.
4. Historical-Linguistics: Examines language evolution and change.

→ Inter-disciplinary Branches

1. Sociolinguistics: Explores language in social contexts.
2. Psycholinguistics: Investigates language processing and acquisition.
3. Applied Linguistics: Applies linguistic knowledge to practical problems.
4. Computational Linguistics: Develops computational models for language processing.
5. Geographical Linguistics: Studies language variation across regions.

→ LINGUISTICS VS. TRADITIONAL GRAMMAR

Linguistics differs from traditional grammar in its:

- Scientific approach
- Emphasis on description over prescription
- Focus on language as a system

→ Linguistics: Scientific Study of Language

Linguistics employs empirical methods to understand language.

→ Linguistics and Descriptivism

Linguistics aims to describe language as it is used, rather than prescribe how it should be used.

→ Linguistics: Non-Speculative Nature

Linguistics relies on observable data, avoiding speculative theories.

➡ **Linguistics and Objectivity**

Linguistics strives for objectivity, separating facts from opinions.

➡ **Nature and Functions of Phonetics**

Phonetics studies the physical properties of speech sounds, examining articulation, acoustic characteristics, and auditory perception.

➡ **Articulatory Phonetics**

Articulatory phonetics investigates how speakers produce speech sounds using vocal organs.

➡ **Acoustic Phonetics**

Acoustic phonetics analyzes the physical properties of speech sounds, such as frequency and amplitude.

➡ **Auditory Phonetics**

Auditory phonetics examines how listeners perceive speech sounds.

➡ **Instrumental Phonetics**

Instrumental phonetics employs tools like spectrographs to analyze speech sounds.

➡ **Phonology and its Branches**

Phonology studies sound patterns in language.

Branches:

- Segmental phonology (individual sounds)
- Suprasegmental phonology (sound patterns beyond individual sounds)
- Prosodic phonology (rhythm and intonation)

➡ **Difference Between Phonetics and Phonology**

Phonetics focuses on individual sounds, while phonology examines sound patterns.

➡ **Phoneme: The Basic Unit of Phonology**

A phoneme is a distinct sound unit in language.

➡ **Segmental Phonology**

Studies individual speech sounds.

➡ **Suprasegmental Phonology**

Examines sound patterns beyond individual sounds.

➡ **Syllable**

A syllable is a unit of sound organization.

➡ **Types of the Syllable**

- Monosyllabic
- Disyllabic
- Polysyllabic

➡ **Consonant Clusters**

Groups of consonants appearing together.

➡ **Abutting Consonants**

Consonants adjacent to each other.

➡ **Stress**

Stress affects syllable prominence.

➡ **Morphology**

Morphology studies word structure.

➡ **Morpheme**

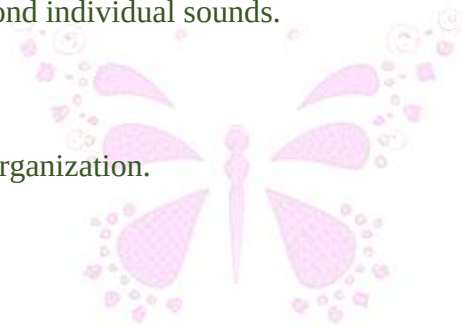
A morpheme is a minimal unit of meaning.

➡ **Free Morphemes**

Morphemes standing alone.

➡ **Bound Morphemes**

Morphemes attached to other morphemes.



Compilation

➡ **Lexical Morphemes**

Content words.

➡ **Functional Morphemes**

Function words.

➡ **Derivational vs. Inflectional Morphemes**

Derivational morphemes change meaning, while inflectional morphemes indicate grammatical function.

➡ **Morphs and Allomorphs**

Variant forms of morphemes.

➡ **Coinage**

Creating new words.

➡ **Borrowing**

Adopting words from other languages.

➡ **Clipping**

Shortening words.

➡ **Acronyms**

Forming words from initials.

➡ **Traditional Grammar**

Focuses on parts of speech and sentence structure.

➡ **Traditional Analysis**

Examines sentence structure.

Compilation

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